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Jillean Williams

Jillean Williams, a poised and delightful Englishwoman, is the wife of Joe Williams. She met Joe in 1957, at the height of his tenure with the Count Basie Band. Jillean and Joe were married in 1959. They currently reside in Las Vegas, Nevada.

Jillean was interviewed by Milt Fillius and Monk Rowe at Hamilton College on May 20, 1995.

MF: This is part of the preparation for the Jazz Archive at Hamilton College, which will deal primarily with the days of the Basie band and the life of Joe Williams. We are pleased to have with us today Jillean Williams, who is the wife of Joe, and who has been part of the scene with the Basie band and with Joe for many years. I'd like to ask you if you would tell us how you first met Joe and how the romance developed into a marriage.

JW: Well there's an old saying that comedians use that they met in a revolving door and they've been going 'round together ever since. But in our case it's actually true. Of course I was working in New York City and some English friends came to town and wanted to celebrate because they were on their way to the U.K. And so we went out for the evening and we went to see George Shearing, who was at The Embers in those days, and then we went on the Waldorf Astoria, where the Count Basie Orchestra was playing with Sarah Vaughan and Joe Williams. We were already familiar with Joe and the band of course and Sarah. And after the show we were down in the lobby going out onto Park Avenue, and I got out onto the street as Joe was coming back in to the hotel because he'd forgotten his putter, which is all-important to him as you probably know. It's still his favorite thing. And so you know I was going out and he was coming in and we glanced at each other, and I found myself left out alone on the street, and realized that he was talking to my friends in the lobby, and Marshall Royal was also there, he was in the band at the time. And we all ended up going to Birdland together, which was great fun. And that's how we initially met. And then later on, Joe came to England, I went back to England and Joe came to England to do a Command Performance. And I tried to contact him, because there was a little something, and I tried to contact him and he was busy or lost my number or something and we missed each other. But then they came back to England later on, a few months later and we met again and we've been going out together ever since.

MR: And what year was that?

JW: We met in 1957. August 1957.

MF: That was not a very tactful question.

JW: Why? I don't mind. Can't hide our ages.

MR: But when you married him he was with the Basie band.

JW: Not actually when we were married, no. But we had been going around together for several years when he was in the Basie band. So there was a certain amount of traveling with the band and following the band and getting to know everyone.

MF: Tell us about the Basie bus.

JW: Oh, the Basie bus was wonderful. I was always very cognizant of the fact that a woman on the bus is like a bump on a log. You know, that's the band's home, it's where they can get off stage and relax and say what they want to say and do what they want to do. And having a strange woman there was really something they didn't need. So one tried to stay in your own little niche you know? I tried to stay with Joe and always sit in the right place, because everybody had assigned seats and you didn't sit over there because that was Sonny Payne's seat, you didn't sit here because that was Marshall Royal's row, and so on. So I tried to stay out of it. But they were always so tolerant. Nobody every made me feel a nuisance you know. You know I inflicted that on myself in fact I think. But I also had the company of Joe Newman's wife, Rigmor, and so there were two of us traveling and we had a wonderful time. We ate tuna out of the can and champagne out of paper cups and it was a great education and great fun.

MF: In the interview we had this morning with Joe and Clark Terry, they talked about Jim Crowism in their travels. Did you run into that at all with the Basie band?

JW: I didn't. If we did I didn't notice it.

MF: You didn't notice it? Well you probably didn't then.

JW: I didn't notice it. I didn't think about it. And I would not go to a place where obviously it would not be approved that Joe and I were together.

MF: Well I wasn't referring to that.

JW: Oh you weren't?

MF: Oh, no, no, no, no, no. That Jim Crow is directed against the blacks. Where, well for example, the bands that used to travel in the south had terrible trouble eating and finding places to stay. And I'm reminded of Calloway who eventually bought himself a rail car, which served as their home every place they went. And I just wondered if the Basie band ran into that, because I've never heard of any problem with the Basie band.

JW: I really didn't notice anything like that. It went over my head if it was there.

MR: Do you find that that idea of big bands traveling like they did is kind of a lost thing now? There's still a few around but, in fact we saw the Basie band about a month ago, but was it a hard life at that point? Because I always wanted to do that. And I always had maybe not a clear picture of what it was really like.

JW: I would think it was hard in the sense that, you know, 13 one-nighters in a row in different towns is pretty tough. So from the point of view of sleeping and eating it was hard. But I think that's what they liked to do because they all loved to play. There was a tremendous spirit of loyalty among the Basie band. And it sort of shows in the way Basie conducts, you know. I mean he only had to point a finger or nod or something and that was his conducting. There was no waving his arms in front of the band. There was a great cohesion in the band. And I think they loved it. I think they enjoyed it. They were just a wonderful group of people.

MF: There's still that cohesion in the alumni I think.

JW: Yes.

MF: I really think so. I don't want to put words in your mouth, but you once told me about after Joe had left the band that he would get up in the middle of the night and go down and see it off.

JW: Oh, yes, absolutely, absolutely. He used to, if the band was leaving at one in the morning to go to drive to Boston or to drive to Philadelphia or somewhere, he would get up and go down to the hotel and just wave them good-bye. You know you never leave the Basie band, to this day if they are within earshot, we're there. You never leave the Basie band. They came back all the time. Joe does quite a lot of concerts with them still, which is fun.

MR: Do you recall who were the, I know in the Basie band they always had great tenor sax players. Do you recall who was in the band at that time?

JW: I recall, if I work really hard I can recall everybody. Well Billy Mitchell was there, sometimes Eddie Davis was there, Lockjaw Davis, Marshall Royal of course was always there, and Poopsie, Charlie Fowlkes was on baritone, and one of our greater friends in the band was Benny Powell, who was a trombone player, and Al Grey and Henry Coker also trombone players, and our absolutely darling friend Freddie Green. Oh, Freddie was just a gem. And Sonny Payne was the drummer and Eddie Jones was the bass player. And we had Joe Newman, Wendell Cully, Thad Jones—

MF: Sweets?

JW: No, Sweets wasn't in the band, Sweets was gone and Clark Terry was gone. Snooky and Thad and Sonny Cohn, and from time to time, when Joe Newman left, Al Arrons came in. But Joe Newman and Joe Williams left the band on the same day.

MF: Oh they did?

JW: Yes. And Mrs. Basie gave them some presentation up at the Apollo I think with Sarah. Sarah was there. We have a picture of it. But I remember all of them. They were wonderful. It was a happy time in my life.

MR: Well we've spoken with a few of those members.

MF: But Joe went on to become a great single, and his own group of course. Were there tough times when he broke loose on his own?

JW: Not professionally tough times, no. I fact I don't know any tough times. Basie saw him off. Basie came up and introduced him on his first single job, which was in Boston, and he went out for a while with Sweets in a group, Jerome Richardson and Sweets, and a wonderful group of musicians. And he always seemed to have work, we never had any bad years that I can remember. So I think he's done real well. And actually he seems to be getting better and better. Everybody thinks his voice is still wonderful.

MF: Well I told you that I think so. I think he and Tony Bennett are the only two musicians of the older ranks whose voices are better now then they were when they were younger. Maybe Mel Torme, maybe.

JW: Yes, Mel— I think you could put Mel in there certainly. He's wonderful. But I think also that they have become, this sounds ridiculous to say at Joe's age, but they've become more sophisticated in their presentation. Joe is now much more than a singer. When he was with Basie, you know, his sort of trademark was that he would come on very serious, and just stand there and sing. You know he never did all this snapping and nodding. Now he's developing a rapport with the audience and he takes the mic and he goes up and down and he talks to people and he makes jokes in between the songs, and it's more of a presentation I think, that relaxes him more too.

MF: He uses his voice more.

JW: Yes.

MF: In more different ways. The falsetto for example that famous recording of "Here's to Life" you know I think is fantastic.

JW: Well his party piece is "In the Evening" when he goes way up high to way down low. That always surprises people. But obviously there's much more freedom when you're a solo performer than when you're with the band, you have to stick to a certain routine.

MR: How many songs would he usually sing on a night with the Basie band?

JW: With the Basie band it would depend on the presentation, but I would say sort of maybe five or six or something like that. Sometimes only three, depending what it was and how many shows they had to do.

MR: Well they put in some long hours on some of those things, didn't they?

JW: Yes they did.

MR: Afternoons and—

JW: But they would play different things. They would sometimes play dances where there was perhaps less for the singer to do. But then people always crowded 'round the stage. People didn't always dance then. I thought that was fun. I didn't know that happened because we didn't have that in England when I lived there.

MF: Oh well it did here.

JW: I know. And the band would play and everybody just takes their partner and sort of stands up and drags them to the front of the stage. And especially when the singer is performing, you know, that gazing into their eyes, and it's great fun. But they don't do a lot of that anymore.

MF: I've noticed Joe seems to be spreading his wings. This new CD that's about to be released or has just been released. Tell us about that one.

JW: Has been — "Feel the Spirit"? That's something Joe has, did he tell you about that? It's something he's wanted to do for absolutely ever since I've known him. Because years ago his great friend was Jimmy Jones, who was a wonderful piano player and arranger. And I've heard him discuss that with Jimmy back in the early 60's that he had this in mind to, he calls it a giving thanks, a giving back for all the fun and pleasure he's had I suppose, and he's been dying to do it. He never could get it on, no one was interested in recording it, until John Snyder of Telarc said he would like to do it and so finally it's been achieved and he's happy with it I think.

MF: Have you heard it?

JW: I've heard most of it, yes.

MF: Do you like it?

JW: I love some of it, yes. You know that Gospel stuff, you can hardly keep still, and he's got Marlena Shaw on some of them too, and she is a knockout. So it's really fun and he loves it. And he's giving the proceeds to a scholarship fund I think.

MF: The one in Nevada?

JW: I don't know about that one, or whether he's going to work up another one. But that's his way of giving back he says.

MF: Tell us about life in Las Vegas, where you guys hang out most of the time.

JW: Well life in Las Vegas is surprisingly dull. We're very quiet when we're at home. We rarely go out, we're very apt to sleep in front of television in the evening, like many other people, and when Joe comes home his pleasure is to be home and eat at home and go and play golf if he feels like it or just sit and relax and listen to his music. And so we don't go out a lot. We hardly ever eat out, and the only things that drag us out are when people like Steve and Edye come to town and we go to one of the hotels where they are and see them, or somebody really special. We just went to see Jack Jones in "Guys and Dolls" just before we came here. And that's the only thing that takes us out. Otherwise we just sit there with our animals and enjoy the climate.

MF: Yes. How many animals do we have right now?

JW: We just have two dogs and three cats.

MF: Oh, you're down to a pretty low—

JW: We're way down, yes. Because I promised Joe that as they left us I would not replace. So I have to be very careful not to overcrowd us.

MR: Can you give me an idea of what the English audience was like for jazz music when you first were going back and forth.

JW: Very enthusiastic. Very enthusiastic, and also in Japan, very enthusiastic. In fact, the jazz artists who have been there say they're better known in these other countries than in the United States. And I remember in Japan a man coming up to Joe with a whole album of things about Hank Jones that we were talking about, he had Hank's whole history, all his records, he had all Joe's stuff, he had all Sweets' stuff. And this is a man in Japanese, a gentleman in Japan. And you know that would be rare here I think. They are much more appreciated overseas.

MF: They are treated like royalty.

JW: Yes.

MF: In Japan and Europe, Switzerland, Germany, all these places.

JW: Yes, which is why so many escape to France and Paris and Johnny Griffin lives in France and some others in Denmark.

MR: Isn't Ernie Wilkins, I think he's—

JW: I don't know if Ernie Wilkins — is Ernie still with us?

MR: I thought so, the musician's union had a Denmark address.

JW: His brother Jimmy lives in Las Vegas. Jimmy Wilkins. He has a band.

MR: And the musicians in England would pick up on American styles, mostly from record I would imagine.

JW: The great band when I was living there was Ted Heath.

MF: Ted Health, yeah. They still play his great recordings.

JW: Yes. And Joe did a wonderful radio show with Ted Heath in which he sang "Old Man River" at breakneck speed, which was a tremendous success, yes. My father, who had never heard Joe sing at that point, listened to it, and he said "that was Joe, my God he can really sing." So it was all very impressive. That was great.

MR: Have you noticed over the years, has Joe been affected by changes in the music business more than, or does he kind of have his own style?

JW: No, he's never changed his belief in what he wants to do. I mean he would never go to rock 'n roll or pop music or country & western.

MR: Right because some people have tried it.

JW: Well people are trying it and I suppose being very successful. One example would be Harry Connick, who used to sing big band stuff and do nice things. He's now gone to pop and noise and rock 'n roll and stuff which is probably making him more money, but it's deserting the cause.

MR: It seemed like he was pretty successful to me.

MF: He was.

JW: And someone who has sort of come back is Barry Manilow, who has done a wonderful big band album.

MF: Oh really?

JW: Yes. So it will never die but it probably won't ever be the same, the big band business.

MF: What do you think the future of jazz is? You know I look at the what I call world class jazz players like Clark Terry for instance, I don't see a Clark Terry on the horizon.

JW: Well I think there are some. Isn't there somebody wonderful called Roy Hargrove who's coming?

MR: Well Clark feels there are.

MF: I know, but—

JW: And Joe goes 'round to colleges and universities, and he is enormously heartened by the music and the sound, and we were in Seattle where they have a choral group with no music, whatever you call that.

MF: A cappella.

JW: A cappella. And there are about eight or a dozen of them. They are terrific. They're called the something sounds, I've forgot. I shouldn't have brought it up if I can't remember the name but I don't remember the name. They are marvelous. And Joe says as long as there are kids making that kind of sound there is certainly hope. And there's a singer at a college in Colorado, who used to be there, I suppose he's graduated now, who did a wonderful imitation of Joe singing, could have been Joe, we had a tape of it. He was wonderful. And I think there are people coming up, and there is certainly enthusiasm for jazz orchestras. We have a very good jazz orchestra at the university in Las Vegas. Frank Gagliardi and the UNLV jazz orchestra. And we have Louie Bellson comes and plays with them, and Joe's done concerts with them. So I think they can be encouraged.

MR: I think they mentioned, the two of them this morning, some of the big differences. There's a lot of the young musicians who spend a lot of time in colleges and learn very technically and so forth, and they have to learn what to do with it later on. Which in the earlier days, when people were mostly listening from records and then getting into the situations and playing in the traveling bands, that hearing things was—either you developed it or you were gone.

MF: They had a lot of good places to let that develop.

JW: Like you have to feel it. Because I'm sure when Clark Terry was coming up there were no courses in jazz. But now you go to school to learn jazz.

MF: And he teaches it.

JW: Yes. And you go to seminars for the weekend to learn jazz. They do that in England. I have a great friend who is a retired doctor who loves piano, but never sort of got the hang of jazz. He plays wonderful music, but he goes to seminars in England to learn jazz. But like you say, that's sort of something that I always thought had to come from inside you, that you made up for yourself.

MR: Yes. It apparently does but it also, as you mentioned, the young students don't have as much opportunity to get out and actually do it in front of people. I mean there are great college bands, and there are some terrific players out there, it's just a little harder for them to really get —to take all those skills and then put them into real life.

MF: Well as you say there are a lot of colleges that have fine, fine big bands. The one in North Texas State or wherever it is down there, and there's one in Colorado and there's one in Las Vegas, and somewhere, I forget where, they have a big contest every year with all these bands. But what do the kids do when they get out of there?

JW: Yes, where do they go?

MF: Where do they develop their skills?

JW: We had a, I don't know if Joe told you this, but he was working in Washington, DC last week and they didn't have a drummer. Norman, who, Norman Simmons booked a drummer who is a student at William Paterson College. Did they tell you this? And his name is Paul Wells. And Norman thought he showed great promise and so he booked him for this job. And Paul had to take finals during the week of the gig. So he said I can't miss this opportunity, so he went to his principal and said, "I have a chance to work for a week with Joe Williams, and could I postpone taking my finals for a while?" They said, "go, go, this is the best experience you'll ever have." So we had him for a week.

MF: Was he okay?

JW: He was terrific. He was a charming young man, 21 years old, very interested, keen, watched Norman like a hawk because he didn't know Joe's music at all. We never met him until the first show, like five minutes before the first show, and Joe had trouble with his name, because it was unfamiliar. Anyway, he really worked hard. He listened to Joe, he listened to Henry Johnson, the guitar player who was helping him, and he just was fantastic. I mean "Roll 'Em Pete" when he has all those exchanges with Joe, he was fabulous. People were applauding in the middle of the song. So there's one that shows promise. But like you say, what does he do when he graduates?

MF: Yeah. What does he do for an encore?

JW: Well maybe he'll go with Joe Williams on the road. But he had a wonderful time and he was awfully good, and that was very encouraging.

MR: Did you ever, when Joe was with the Basie band, and they did some recordings, and I'm wondering if you ever got to see that process?

JW: No, I never saw Joe and the Basie band record, no. I went to a number of recordings. I feel very privileged being with Joe to have met so many wonderful people. I remember going to a Nat King Cole recording once in New York. That was great. Nat sang with his hat on all the time, that was the only thing that bothered me, he had that checkered hat that he used to wear.

MF: But what came out was pretty good.

JW: Right, that was great. I've been to a lot of recording sessions, but never with the band.

MF: I find, I believe from the records that I have and have played that every singer I know of sings better with the Basie band than anybody else. Sinatra for one. Tony Bennett, Sarah Vaughan. There's a whole collection. All the great vocalists recorded with Basie at one time or another. And you put them all together and they're just fabulous. Have you ever listened to them?

JW: But nobody holds a candle to Joe Williams and the Basie band.

MF: Oh I understand that.

JW: All these people, all these wonderful names, these wonderful professionals who are big, big stars, have never come up to Joe in the Basie band. Don't you agree with that?

MF: Yes.

JW: Or am I prejudiced?

MF: No, you're absolutely right. But understand what I'm saying. I'm saying they sing better—

JW: With the band.

MF: With the band than they do with Nelson or anybody. They have a different timbre in their voices. They just, you know that rhythm is incredible.

JW: Yes. Well there's a spark in the Basie band that the others don't have.

MR: Can you tell us a little more about Freddie Green?

JW: Oh, what can I tell you about Freddie? He was just a wonderful steady influence going through the band all the time. He was very retiring, you know he never got in the way or showed off or was obvious anywhere, he just was there, pounding away and being sweet and charming.

MF: Besides being the rock of the rhythm section he was the rock of the people too.

JW: Yes. He was also a very keen golfer. He was responsible for Joe becoming a golf junkie because Joe joined the band with tennis rackets, but he probably has told you. And within a very short time, nobody played tennis, so they hauled him out on the golf course, Freddie Green and Marshall Royal I think. And from then on he was lost to golf and the tennis racket rotted away somewhere.

MF: We just lost Marshall as you know.

JW: Yes, very sad.

MF: There has been a rumor around for years that Marshall and Basie had trouble because Basie wouldn't give Marshall solo time. Is that kind of hard or—

JW: I don't know anything about that. But Basie did give Marshall solo time.

MF: Well I know that, but he wasn't featured the way Lockjaw Davis and Lester Young and all the tenors were. You know and I talked to Marshall and I never had the nerve to ask him, but I was going to see that he was asked in these interviews, and now we won't get him.

JW: Marshall was always like in charge of the band.

MF: Yeah. He was the concertmaster.

JW: And he conducted the band and so on at times—

MF: And you know he never lost that. He'd have a group at a jazz party and he'd just take over.

JW: Well he was very efficient at his job and he knew what he was doing. He was there 20 years. That's a long haul, traveling on the bus.

MF: Except for Freddie Green.

JW: Except for Freddie, yes that's right.

MR: I just read a story in this jazz anecdotes book about Freddie Green and that when Freddie got his first amplifier he wanted to do some soloing himself, and the guys in the band said that every time he went to solo, the rhythm section would like not happen because he wasn't— so they would start sabotaging his amp every night. So he'd go to do a solo and he'd have to go back to this, and he finally just gave up. Now I don't know if it's true, but it's a great—

MF: Well he has one solo, I've forgotten what tune it's on, which was a big joke — it's one chord.

JW: It's in "L'il Darling" I think.

MF: Yeah.

JW: At the beginning of "L'il Darling" he goes [scats]. But we've got a record of Freddie singing, "Them There Eyes" I think it is. Yes, my cousin Andrew is a great jazz collector, and he sent Joe a tape of Freddie singing years ago. I can't remember what the occasion was, but he was quite reasonable. It was sort of like a joke I think.

MF: Not with Basie?

JW: I think with Basie. Well not standing up in front of the band, but singing "Them There Eyes" with a band so I imagine it was Basie.

MF: I'll be darned.

JW: So he did do other things.

MF: But he's always been considered the rock of the band. And you've been through so many wonderful people in that band, haven't you?

JW: Absolutely, yes, my goodness. There are so many good friends.

MF: I was just going to say I'll bet you have lots of good friends.

JW: Lots of good friends. Well Benny Powell was always a good friend in the days when we were all in the band, and John Williams is an absolute doll. He's the baritone player now with the band. He is the nicest man in the world. And we knew Tee Carson quite well when he was playing piano. We saw him recently in San Francisco at the Fairmont. And well Bill Hughes of course, who's been there forever.

MR: We saw Bill Hughes and Frank Foster together, and they gave us some wonderful things.

JW: Frank Foster and we used to live in the same building in New York. Yes, we used to meet in the laundry room.

MF: They did Foster and Hughes for this series.

JW: Oh yes, oh, good, great. That should be good. Basie is still like a big cloud over all of it you know, he's still got his arms around everyone.

MF: He always will be. Because he was the key. Clark Terry this morning, it's often been written that the real secret to Bill Basie was that he always knew the right tempo for a tune. And Clark told a story of "L'il Darling?"

MR: Yeah, when Neal Hefti brought it in.

MF: When Neal Hefti brought it in and said, "here's the tempo." And Basie says, "no, this is the tempo." And they played it that way and it was a huge hit. And as Clark says, if they'd played it with Hefti's speed, it would have been another "who heard of it?"

JW: Yes, it would have been gone long ago.

MF: But he had that, and that — I mean he had sort of a mystic — I mean all the people I've ever met who played in the band, speak of him with reverence. And I don't know, that's not true, even Ellington, who is a great one, there are people who played with Ellington who don't speak highly of him. And certainly there are people who played with Benny Goodman who don't speak highly of him. In fact it's hard to find one who does.

MR: Yes. He's quite a legend with that.

JW: Benny Goodman stories are wonderful. They're all very funny stories of things he did.

MF: Yes. But Basie had something, that you know your husband still reveres him.

JW: Oh, absolutely. He still calls him Mr. Basie. Always calls him Mr. Basie.

MR: A couple of the players have mentioned — that we've seen — that they had never played in any other bands that could swing at a soft and slow tempo like that. That's one of the hardest things for bands to do, is to be soft and slow but still be happening.

JW: All those wonderful Nestico arrangements that nobody plays them like the Basie band, all of those, "Queen Bee" and lovely things that he arranged. Terrific.

MF: Well there's a whole library of stuff that nobody plays like Basie. Even the current Basie band doesn't play it as well as they were. Although the new Basie band is not all that bad.

JW: I haven't heard them for a while. I think I hardly would know anybody left in the band. I mean Bill Hughes and John Williams probably.

MF: You know Frank Foster.

JW: Oh, I know Frank yes. I don't count Frank. He's just there all the time. No I'm thinking of the players. And the bass player I sort of know.

MF: Sonny Cohn is gone.

JW: Sonny's gone.

MR: I forget, the name, was it like, Cleveland [Eaton].

JW: Cleveland. Not Grover Cleveland, that was a president. And there was Grover Mitchell who used to be in the band.

MR: Yeah, there are some kind of young players now, they've got to carry it on.

JW: But it's something to be in the Basie band, and so they had a standard to keep up.

MF: I was always surprised to see Kenny Hing sitting there.

JW: Yes, little Kenny. Oh Kenny's a good friend, too.

MF: But you know, the horn is bigger than he is.

JW: Yes, isn't it? And he gets up and the horn sort of dwarfs him.

MF: It's like Scott Hamilton when he first came out, he was just 40 pounds dripping wet. And that horn was bigger than he was.

JW: You know who else was a nice person in the band, Danny Turner, who also just recently passed away. Did you know Danny?

MF: Who?

JW: Danny Turner?

MF: No.

JW: And he was an alto player. And he was very nice and very sweet. He just died about three weeks ago.

MF: No, I didn't know him.

JW: You would know him if you saw him.

MF: Oh, probably yes.

JW: He was very unobtrusive, and a small guy. He sat next to Kenny Hing.

MF: Okay. It's was hard for me to get past Kenny Hing. Well this has been wonderful.

JW: Well thank you.

MF: Do you have any words of wisdom that you'd like to leave our watchers? You know we're going to extract some of this and stick it in a Joe Williams documentary.

JW: Well I just wish that all orchestra wives, if that's the word, could be as lucky as I feel I have been.

MF: Well this is really not part of the documentary but I must say to you that I think Joe has been very, very fortunate to have you.

JW: Oh, well I thank you very much.

MF: And I still say that the 70th birthday party that you put on for him in Las Vegas was the greatest party I've ever been to. It was absolutely fabulous.

JW: I thought that was fun I must say. We had the Basie band and George Shearing played, uninvited, in fact he couldn't stop, he was enjoying himself.

MF: He started to play the introduction to "Every Day," and said, "Joe, get up here and sing" in the Basie band.

JW: It was great fun.

MF: Yeah, it was a great party.

MR: Thank you very much.

JW: Thank you. I hope you can extract something.

MF: Oh, we will. Okay wrap it.